# Pedro Javier Torres López

PhD Candidate in Social Policy, London School of Economics

*International Inequalities Institute · CEEY*

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GitHub • Google Scholar • LinkedIn

On the 2026–27 academic job market

## FIELDS

Development and Public Economics · Applied Microeconomics
Computational Social Science · Applied Econometrics

## EDUCATION

**PhD in Social Policy** 2023 – 2027 *(expected)*
London School of Economics London, UK

- **Thesis:** *Data Driven Solutions for Distributional Analyses of Poverty and Inequality*
- **Supervisors:** Stephen Jenkins and Francisco Ferreira

**MSc Applied Social Data Science** 2022 – 2023
London School of Economics London, UK

- **Dissertation:** *From Rags to Riches? The Impact of Education Reform on Intergenerational Social Mobility in Mexico*

**BSc Economics** 2016 – 2020
Universidad Iberoamericana Mexico City, Mexico

- **Thesis:** *Wage Gaps due to Indigenous Self-Identification and Linguistic Traits in Mexico*

## JOB MARKET PAPER

**Bias Reduction in TSTSLS Applications: A Quantile Adjustment Method**

Latest version: November 2026 [PDF] [R package]

Many research questions require income and a second variable measured for the same people, but the two are often recorded in separate samples. Two-sample two-stage (TSTS) imputation bridges the samples by predicting income from characteristics both record. However, the predictions are less dispersed than actual income, and they miss any link between income and the second variable that the shared characteristics do not capture. Existing corrections fix these problems one at a time, and fixing only the first can make an estimate worse. I propose a quantile adjustment that replaces each prediction with the observed income at the same rank. It restores the income distribution and, in the same step, shifts the covariance with the second variable. I characterise when this shift helps and provide two diagnostics. In applications to Mexico, Ecuador and Chile, the adjustment comes closest to the full-sample benchmark on 14 of 19 estimands and within 0.6 percentage points of the best method on the other 5.

## PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

- Plassot, T., Soloaga, I. and **Torres López, P.J.** "Inequality of Opportunity in Mexico and its Regions: A Data-Driven Approach." *The Journal of Development Studies*, 58(9), 1857–1873, 2022. [DOI]
- Arceo-Gómez, E.O. and **Torres López, P.J.** "Brechas salariales por autoidentificación indígena y rasgos lingüísticos en México." *Sobre México. Temas de Economía*, 1(3), 129–161, 2021. [DOI]

## WORKING PAPERS

- Brunori, P., Ferreira, F.H.G., Peragine, V., Salas-Rojo, P. et al., incl. **Torres López, P.J.** "International Variation in Inequality of Opportunity: Insights from 72 Countries." Research Square preprint, 2026. **R&R at *Nature***. [Paper] [Database]
- **Torres López, P.J.**, Monroy-Gómez-Franco, L.A. and Vélez-Grajales, R. "Survey-to-Survey Imputation

When External Covariates Matter: Estimating Inequality of Opportunity in Mexico." CEEY Working Paper, 2025. [Paper]

- Aguilar-Gómez, S., Arceo-Gómez, E.O., De la Cruz Toledo, E. and **Torres López, P.J.** "Follow the Leader? Public Health Messaging and Containment of Mobility During a Pandemic." UNDP Working Paper, 2022. [Paper]

## BOOK CHAPTERS

- Woo-Mora, L.G. and **Torres López, P.J.** "New Echoes of Deep Mexico? Indigenous Identity and Its Enduring Imprints." In F. Valencia Caicedo (ed.), *Roots of Underdevelopment: A New Economic (and Political) History of Latin America and the Caribbean*, Volume 2, 2026. [SSRN]

## WORK IN PROGRESS

- **Torres López, P.J.** "Estimating Intergenerational Mobility: A Machine Learning Approach."
- **Torres López, P.J.** "From Rags to Riches? The Impact of Education Reform on Intergenerational Social Mobility in Mexico."

## RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

**Research Analyst** 2022 – present
International Inequalities Institute, LSE London, UK

- Design and implement econometric pipelines for inequality of opportunity analysis across multiple countries and survey datasets.
- Build and maintain the GEOM database and its public web platform, covering data ingestion, cleaning, version control and deployment.
- Contribute to collaborative research outputs used by academics, NGOs and international policy institutions.

**External Research Consultant** 2023 – present
Centro de Estudios Espinosa Yglesias (CEEY) Mexico City, Mexico

- Develop the quantile adjustment method for survey-to-survey income imputation across household surveys with incompatible designs.
- Produce working papers and policy reports on intergenerational inequality and social mobility in Mexico.

## TEACHING EXPERIENCE

**Class Teacher, *Inequality and Poverty Analysis* (EC210)** 2024, 2025, 2026
LSE Summer School Lecturers: Stephen Jenkins and Berkay Ozcan

- Class Teacher Award, 2025.
- Student evaluation 2025: 4.91 out of 5 (23 responses from 31 enrolled students).

**Problem Sets and Office Hours,** 2023–24, 2024–25
***Causal Inference for Observational and Experimental Studies* (MY457)**
London School of Economics, Winter Term Lecturer: Daniel de Kadt

**Teaching statement:** [PDF]

**Teaching materials:** *Measuring Inequality of Opportunity*, slides with a hands-on implementation in R. [Slides]

## SOFTWARE

- **tstsqa** (R package). Implements the quantile adjustment method from the job market paper, with predictor screening and regime diagnostics. [GitHub]
- **GEOM** (R functions, with P. Brunori and P. Salas-Rojo). Ex-ante and ex-post inequality of opportunity estimation for the GEOM database. [GitHub]

## POLICY WRITING (IN SPANISH)

- "El mérito no basta: por qué México necesita igualdad de oportunidades." *Este País*, August 2026. [Read]
- "México y su escalera educativa: todos suben, pero unos empiezan desde el sótano." *Este País*, May 2026. [Read]

## INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE

**Financial and Operational Risk Analyst** 2020 – 2022
Banco de México Mexico City, Mexico

- Automated risk reporting workflows and produced performance dashboards for the Long-Term Reserve investment portfolio.
- Managed the Fund's external communication strategy across its website and social media channels.

## AWARDS

- Class Teacher Award, EC210 *Inequality and Poverty Analysis*, LSE Summer School, 2025.

## COMPUTATIONAL SKILLS

**Programming:** R, Python, Stata

**Data and infrastructure:** SQL, Apache Spark, Git, HTML/CSS, LaTeX

**Methods:** Causal inference, distributional and quantile methods, machine learning, survey imputation

## LANGUAGES

**Spanish** (native) **English** (fluent) **German** (fluent)

## REFERENCES

**Stephen Jenkins**
Department of Social Policy
London School of Economics
[LSE profile]

**Francisco Ferreira**
International Inequalities Institute
London School of Economics
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**Berkay Ozcan**
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